remain in slavery.' The Hindu nation had been enslaved by inappropriate Westernisation.

Even the language in which the Constitution had been drafted betrayed this reality: 'If the original draft of the Constitution had been in Hindi or in any other Indian language', he felt, the 'un-Indian element' would not have been as dominant. But his concerns, of course, went well beyond language. The Constitution's core conception of the nation, in his view, was fundamentally not Indian at all: 'in the constitution, as it is now, it is the sentiments of the English that have found better expression than those of the Indians,' observed Upadhyaya. 'Thus, our constitution, like an English child born in India, has become Anglo-Indian in character, instead of purely Indian.'[52]

Upadhyaya thus questioned the very legitimacy of the Constitution and not just the process by which it was created. For Upadhyaya, the absence of the Hindu Rashtra idea in the Constitution was unacceptable. For him *dharma* had to be the central idea behind governance and nation-building. He categorically repudiated the secularists' view that *dharma* is an entirely personal matter, that it had nothing to do with society or nation. On the contrary, Upadhyaya argued that there is undoubtedly a supreme purpose to life, which transcended all differences and peculiarities of caste, sect, or language. This purpose is not a worldly one—it does not consist of seeking to erect a huge political empire or to dominate the world militarily. Indeed, militarism and temporal power, Upadhyaya wrote, were not a Hindu preoccupation. Hindus had never shed the blood of other peoples or perpetrated atrocities on other countries as Alexander, Genghis Khan, Mahmud of Ghazni—non-Hindu conquerors all—had done. Hindus had, instead, always given a warm welcome and shelter to refugee groups like the Parsis and the Jews, who had become the victims of aggression and atrocities elsewhere and had fled to India.

In keeping with his distaste for foreign concepts and terms, Upadhyaya explicated his beliefs through the use of Sanskrit terms to which he ascribed specific contemporary meanings. A favourite word of Upadhyaya's is '*chiti*', which he labels the 'soul power' of a nation. He describes this soul power through a homely analogy: a barber told his